

Once You Invest in Andhra, It Is No Longer Your Project. It Is Ours

Nara Lokesh, Andhra Pradesh Minister for Information Technology, Electronics & Communications and Human Resource Development, on the state's journey to becoming a manufacturing hub till 2047

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ANDHRA PRADESH IS positioning itself as one of the frontrunners in manufacturing, banking on electronics, semiconductors, data centres, green energy and digital infrastructure to drive its next phase of growth. The state has been featured as the Fastest-growing Major State in GSVA from Manufacturing over the five-year period from FY20 to FY25, according to the BT study.

In an interview with *Business Today*, Andhra Pradesh Minister for Information Technology, Electronics & Communications and Human Resource Development, Nara Lokesh, outlines the state's strategy to attract global investments, create jobs, strengthen its technology ecosystem and

build Andhra Pradesh into a future-ready manufacturing hub. Edited Excerpts:



What is your government's long-term vision for making the state a manufacturing hub by 2047?

By 2047, when India celebrates 100 years of Independence, Andhra Pradesh will be one of the world's most competitive manufacturing destinations. We are building an economy anchored in advanced manufacturing, AI, clean energy, and global exports. Manufacturing is not merely factories; it is about creating quality jobs, strengthening supply chains, driving innovation and raising incomes of millions of families. The state is developing world-class industrial nodes, logistics infrastructure, ports, airports, digital connectivity, and skilled talent simultaneously. We want companies to see Andhra Pradesh not just as a place to manufacture for India, but as a base to serve global markets. Our objective is to make Andhra Pradesh the preferred destination for companies looking for speed, scale, and long-term policy certainty.



Which sectors will drive Andhra Pradesh's next phase of industrial growth: electronics, semiconductors, defence, EVs, renewable energy, food processing, or others?

The future belongs to integrated industrial ecosystems rather than isolated sectors. We are building 22 industrial clusters that are integrated both horizontally and vertically. Electronics and advanced manufacturing will be major growth drivers. Renewable energy and energy storage are creating a new industrial base. Defence and aerospace manufacturing offer significant opportunities given our strategic location and industrial capabilities. Food processing will continue to add value to our agricultural strengths.

We are also investing heavily in data centres, AI infrastructure, quantum technologies, and advanced manufacturing because these sectors reinforce each other.

For example, reliable clean energy supports data centres; data centres attract AI companies; AI improves manufacturing productivity. Our goal is to create multiple engines of growth that complement one another rather than relying on a single sector.



The state enjoys a strategic coastline and several ports. How do you plan to leverage